

active immunity	A form of acquired immunity in which the body produces its own antibodies against disease-causing antigens. Can be due to a previous infection (natural) or a vaccine (artificial)
airborne transmission	The spread of a disease in aerosol form (suspended in air). e.g. spores
Antibiotic Resistance	The evolution of populations of pathogenic bacteria that antibiotics are unable to kill. Due to some bacteria having a favourable mutation which keeps them alive and they then reproduce.
Antibiotics	Drugs that destroy/kill bacteria
Antibodies	Special proteins which destroys/kills pathogens (made by white blood cells)
Antigen	A substance on the outside of a pathogen that is detected by white blood cells.
Bacteria	A single-celled microorganism. They may cause disease by rapidly reproducing and making toxins which damage our cells.
Capsid	Outer protein coat of a virus
direct transmission	Transmission of blood or body fluids through touching (including shaking hands), kissing, coughing, sneezing, and talking.
droplet transmission	occurs through contact with contaminated respiratory droplets spread by a cough or sneeze

external defences	Structures which prevent the entry of pathogens such as skin, mucus, lysozyme and acid
fever	helps fight infection by raising the body temp above the optimum temperature for the pathogen to live and reproduce
Flagellum	A long, whip-like structure that grows out of a cell and enables the cell to move.
host	An organism on which a parasite lives.
host specific	capable of living solely on or in one species of host which has a specific receptor
Immunity	the ability of an organism to resist a particular infection or toxin by the action of specific antibodies or white blood cells.
indirect transmission	Transmission through contact with an intermediate contaminated object e.g. an environmental surface (doorknob, railing etc).
Lymphocyte	A type of white blood cell that make antibodies to fight off infections
Main types of bacteria	cocci, spirali, bacilli
memory cells	General term for lymphocytes that are responsible for immunological memory and protective immunity.

parasite	An organism that lives on or in a host and causes harm to the host
passive immunity	An individual does not produce his or her own antibodies, but rather receives them directly from another source, such as mother to infant through breast milk (natural) or a vaccine (artificial)
Pathogen	A microorganism that causes disease
phagocyte	A white blood cell that destroys pathogens by engulfing them and breaking them down
pilli	Short, hair-like protein structures used to help bacteria attach to host cells
Vaccine	A harmless variant or weakened form of a pathogen that stimulates a host's immune system to mount defenses against the pathogen
vector transmission	transmission of an infectious agent by an insect or animal
Virus	A microorganism that causes disease by replicating inside cells causing damage.
virus cycles	lytic and lysogenic
White blood cells	a.k.a. leukocytes - Cells that fight disease by: 1) Making antibodies that kill pathogens 2) Ingesting / engulfing pathogens 3) Making antitoxins that counteract the toxins made by bacteria